

JOSEPH BALESH

MONITORING & IMPACT EVALUATION SPECIALIST

Lebanon | +961 71 001786 | joe.balesh@gmail.com | LinkedIn: Joseph Balesh

PROFESSIONAL PROFILE

Senior monitoring, evaluation and impact specialist with 13+ years of experience supporting humanitarian and development programmes across Lebanon, Liberia and global portfolios. Experienced in designing KPI and monitoring frameworks, coordinating field assessments, measuring outputs and outcomes, analyzing complex data, and presenting actionable findings to management and programme teams. Combines strong field-monitoring experience with practical data systems, impact analysis, donor reporting and continuous-improvement approaches.

CORE COMPETENCIES

Monitoring & Evaluation Frameworks: KPI frameworks, baselines, targets, monitoring plans and evaluation approaches

Performance & Data Quality: Databases, validation, traceable evidence, quality checks and performance tracking

Corrective Action & Learning: Deviation analysis, recommendations, lessons learned and adaptive improvement

Operational Coordination: Implementation-team collaboration, workplans, reporting calendars and follow-up

Field Monitoring & Assessments: Field visits, surveys, KIs, FGDs, observation and digital data collection

Impact Analysis & Reporting: Outcome analysis, evaluation findings, donor reports and management presentations

Executive Dashboards: Power BI, advanced Excel, KPI scorecards and automated performance reporting

Capacity Strengthening: Training, coaching, SOPs, guidance, documentation and system adoption

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Georges N. Frem Foundation (GNFF) | Lebanon

MEAL & Data Systems Specialist | Apr 2024 – Present

- Lead monitoring, evaluation and data-system support across agriculture, education, youth, transport, cultural and emergency-response portfolios, aligning KPIs, monitoring plans and reporting with organizational priorities.
- Develop KPI frameworks, IPTTs, annual and periodic monitoring calendars, survey instruments and assessment approaches for trainings, events, field visits, distributions and follow-up activities.
- Coordinate quantitative and qualitative assessments, including baseline, endline, satisfaction, follow-up and stakeholder studies, and translate findings into practical recommendations for programme improvement.
- Designed centralized databases, automated trackers and Power BI/Excel dashboards that give management timely visibility of targets, progress, outputs, outcomes and implementation gaps.
- Monitor performance against indicators and workplans, strengthen evidence and data-quality controls, identify deviations or risks, and support teams in defining corrective follow-up actions.
- Established cross-department data-collection workplans defining responsibilities, timing and quality checks; built team buy-in by linking timely data entry to faster analysis, dashboards and programme decisions.
- Analyze programme results and beneficiary perspectives, document lessons learned, and facilitate reflection with teams so recommendations are realistic, assigned and followed through.

Mercy Corps – Global | Remote / Global

Senior Analytics Officer, Research & Analytics for Adaptive Management (RAAM) | Sep 2023 – Mar 2024

- Supported completion and testing of the RAAM toolkit by developing practical templates, detailed guidance and instructions for applying analytical methods.
- Worked with country MEL teams to assess existing analytics practices, test tools with programme datasets and refine materials based on user feedback.
- Provided technical support, training and structured guidance to help geographically dispersed teams adopt the toolkit and use analysis for adaptive management.
- Contributed to data review materials, case studies, learning products and project progress inputs for internal and external audiences.

Mercy Corps – Lebanon | Lebanon

MEL Coordinator, FORSA II | Sep 2019 – May 2023

- Led the programme's monitoring and evaluation system, overseeing framework implementation, indicator tracking, field data collection, verification, analysis, documentation and donor-facing reporting.
- Built and managed digital data-collection and reporting workflows using CommCare and Excel, improving visibility of participant progress, activity delivery and results.

- Developed data-collection workplans and reporting calendars with programme teams, clarifying who collects each data point, when it is due and how quality is checked.
- Used consultation and practical coaching to secure team ownership of routine data entry, reducing repeated data requests and enabling more timely analysis and reporting.
- Prepared performance findings for programme leadership, supported evaluations and learning reviews, and worked with implementation teams to turn evidence into corrective actions and delivery improvements.

Mercy Corps – Lebanon | Lebanon

MEL Senior Officer | Aug 2017 – Nov 2019

- Managed project monitoring, databases, field assessments and performance reporting for livelihoods and youth-focused humanitarian and development programming.
- Designed tracking tools and supported quantitative and qualitative data collection, cleaning, validation, analysis and presentation for programme management.
- Co-developed activity-level data workplans with field teams, setting submission timelines, responsibilities and verification steps to keep monitoring data complete and analysis-ready.
- Conducted field monitoring and compliance spot checks against implementation plans and quality expectations; documented findings, beneficiary feedback, deviations and recommended follow-up actions.
- Produced dashboards, periodic evaluation summaries and learning inputs that helped programme teams identify implementation gaps and adjust delivery.

Mercy Corps – Liberia | Liberia

LEEP Trainer / Technical Assignment | Mar 2021 – May 2021

- Delivered practical training and technical support to strengthen team capacity in programme systems, data use and implementation practices within a multicultural field environment.
- Adapted training content to operational needs and supported participants to apply learning through structured guidance, exercises and follow-up.

United Nations World Food Programme (WFP) | Lebanon

Monitoring Assistant | 2012 – 2017

- Conducted regular field monitoring of food-assistance activities and partner implementation, assessing delivery against plans and quality requirements and documenting risks, beneficiary feedback and follow-up actions.
- Maintained and validated beneficiary and monitoring data, supported assessments and contributed to accurate operational reports for management and programme stakeholders.
- Coordinated monitoring schedules and structured data-submission routines with partners and field colleagues, clarifying timelines and quality expectations to support consistent reporting.
- Resolved discrepancies through verification and follow-up with beneficiaries and partners, strengthening accountability and timely programme delivery.

SELECTED TECHNICAL TOOLS

Advanced Microsoft Excel • Power BI • CommCare • KoboToolbox • Microsoft Office • Google Workspace • Digital survey tools • Centralized databases • Automated trackers and reporting workflows

EDUCATION

Master's in International Business Administration

Bachelor's in Information Management

LANGUAGES

Arabic: Native | English: Fluent | French: Basic conversational proficiency